SHREYASHI BISTA

Kathmandu, Nepal
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ResearchGate: Shreyashi Bista

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Human-wildlife conflict and coexistence • Large carnivore ecology and conservation • Human-tiger coexistence • Spatial ecology • Conservation social science • Conservation governance • Environmental justice • Political ecology

EDUCATION

MSc Sustainability and Environmental Management | *Coventry University, United Kingdom* 2025-2026

Academic requirements completed; formal graduation pending. Dissertation: Can Compensation Care? A Care Ethics Analysis of Nepal's Wildlife Damage Relief Guidelines: A Case Study of Shuklaphanta National Park. Dissertation awarded Distinction.

MSc Environmental Science (Wildlife Ecology and Management) | *Kathmandu University, Nepal* 2022-2024

GPA: 3.68/4.00. Dissertation: Distribution of Asiatic Black Bear (Ursus thibetanus) and its conflict with humans in Gaurishankar Conservation Area, Nepal.

BSc Forestry | *Institute of Forestry, Tribhuvan University, Nepal* 2017-2021

Overall: 76.45%. Dissertation: Distribution of invasive alien plant species and their influence on mammals' habitat selection in Shuklaphanta National Park, Nepal.

PUBLICATIONS

- **Bista, S.**, Raut, N., Neupane, S. S., Odden, M., & Chetri, M. (2026). Ecological and social dimensions of human-bear coexistence in Nepal's Gaurishankar Conservation Area. *Ecology and Evolution, 16*(6), e73776. https://doi.org/10.1002/ece3.73776
  First and corresponding author
- Neupane, B., Dhami, B., **Bista, S.**, Sadadev, B. M., Regmi, S., Shrestha, S., Shrestha, B., Traxmandlova, I., Varachova, S., & Kindlmann, P. (2022). Ecological factors determining barking deer distribution and habitat use in the mid-hills of Nepal. *Frontiers in Ecology and Evolution.*
- **Bista, S.** *(Under review).* Can compensation care? A care ethics analysis of Nepal's wildlife damage relief guidelines: A case study of Shuklaphanta National Park.

RESEARCH AND POLICY EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant - NBSAP Revision | *UNDP Nepal* Jul 2024-Aug 2025

Supported development of the Global Biodiversity Framework target on human-wildlife conflict and integration of Gender Equality and Social Inclusion (GESI) into Nepal's NBSAP.

Research Assistant (Consultant) - Human-Tiger Conflict Project | *WWF Nepal* Aug-Oct 2024

Conducted household surveys, focus group discussions and key informant interviews; supported community-level social data collection and analysis for a GESI Strategy and Action Plan.

Consultant - Youth and Climate Project | *British Council Nepal* Mar-May 2024

Led a community-based project on women's leadership and sustainable climate adaptation with the Badi community in Kanchanpur District.

Intern | *Shuklaphanta National Park* Feb-Jun 2021

Participated in human-wildlife conflict field visits, wildlife patrols, conservation awareness, data analysis and registration of wildlife-damage compensation claims.

RESEARCH FUNDING, SCHOLARSHIPS AND AWARDS

- Rufford Small Grant (2022) - Research funding for Asiatic black bear distribution and human-bear coexistence in Gaurishankar Conservation Area, Nepal.
- WWF-Nepal Memorial Grant (2022) - Scholarship support for MSc study in Environmental Science at Kathmandu University.
- NORPART Scholarship (2022) - Fully funded Master's exchange at Inland Norway University of Applied Sciences, Norway.
- IDEA WILD Equipment Grant (2023) - Field equipment support for wildlife ecology and conservation research.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS AND ACADEMIC ENGAGEMENT

Student Conference on Conservation Science, University of Cambridge | *Poster presentation* 2026

Distribution of Asiatic Black Bear, Ursus thibetanus and its conflict with humans in Gaurishankar Conservation Area, Nepal.

Student Conference on Conservation Science, New York | *Poster presentation* 2022

Invasive alien plant species and their influence on mammal habitat selection.

Youth and Climate Symposium | *British Council* 2024

Presented a community-based project on women's leadership and sustainable climate adaptation.

RESEARCH METHODS AND TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Ecological and spatial methods: wildlife field surveys; habitat assessment; ecological data collection and analysis; GIS and spatial analysis; biodiversity monitoring; field research techniques.
- Social and qualitative methods: household questionnaires; focus group discussions; key informant interviews; community engagement; participatory fieldwork; human-wildlife conflict research.
- Policy and governance: policy and document analysis; biodiversity-policy implementation and monitoring; conservation governance; GESI integration.

SELECTED TRAINING AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- Collective Reflective Learning for Social Inclusion in Nepal's Community-Based Natural Resource Management - IWMI Nepal, University of Edinburgh and Gender at Work (2023).
- Wildlife Research Techniques Training - Friends of Nature, Nepal (19 days, 2019).
- 6th Annual Field Course in Conservation Biology & Global Health: At the Human-Environment Interface - Nepal Engineering College with the University of Washington, Seattle, USA.
- WomenDior & UNESCO Paris Mentorship Program (2024/2025).

ADDITIONAL PROFESSIONAL AND PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

Website Content Management Assistant - Food Green City Project | *UNDP Nepal* — May-Oct 2023

Supported digital engagement of 16 municipalities in monitoring and reporting Food Green City progress.

Communication Support | *RECOFTC Nepal* — Jun-Sep 2022

Supported training, reporting and communication materials for gender advocacy in Nepal's forestry sector.

Editorial Team Member | *GlobalNYT, Denmark* — 2025-Present

Contribute environmental and sustainability writing for an international editorial platform.